year, or two, which they must waste in idleness, hunger, dirt, and with companions much improved by such education. If that prison be not secure, send them into still worse company; that of abandoned felons in the county gaol. What is this but devoting them to destruction? Many may date the total loss of every principle of honour and virtue, from their confinement in these schools of wickedness.

Every county and town that has a bridewell should be careful to see, first of all, that it be suitable to the purpose. In many places the county gaol is also a bridewell. But this prison ought to be quite separate from the gaol: at least not within the same walls: nor should even the courtyard be common to both. The building must be proportioned to the general number of delinquents. None of the rooms for confinement should be lower than the ground floor; rather a story above it. Each workroom should have a thoroughfare for air: but the opposite windows need not be equal; the back windows half the size of those in front, and six feet from the floor.[1] Few or none of the windows should have glass; only blinds, similar to what are used in distilleries; or shutters, and these should be open several hours in the day. The rooms, where the windows are not glazed, should have fireplaces. The windows should be by no means towards the street, that spirituous liquors or files, etc. may not be conveyed to the prisoners. In the courtyard (for such is necessary in every prison [2]) there should be a pump, or some other provision for water in plenty. And prisoners should be permitted to walk about, when they have done working.

For in work they ought, most certainly, to be employed. This is indispensably requisite. Not one should be idle, that is not sick.[3] Where the prisoners are numerous, there should

[1] In all large rooms, where there are numbers of people, provision should be made for letting out the vitiated air at the top of them. See *Dr. Priestley's Experiments*, etc., p. 281.

[2] By an act seventh James I cap. iv it is required that there be in every county "one or more fit and convenient house or houses of correction, with convenient backside thereunto adjoining . . . Every justice of peace within every county . . . where such house and backside shall not be erected or provided," (within about two years) "shall forfeit for his said neglect, five pounds of lawful English money"; one moiety to the informer, the other towards erecting, building, etc., the said house and backside.—And an act made in Ireland the tenth and eleventh of Charles I requireth same, under the like penalty for neglect.

[3] Many are committed to bridewell to live in idleness. Some warrants do not order them to labour. Magistrates should consider that prisoners confined for one or two years are entirely ruined; not only as to morals, but as to their capacity for labour; for I have known some on going to work, immediately fall into a decline.

be several workrooms; and but few prisoners in one room. Those who work by compulsion are more likely to be seduced to idleness in large companies, than when they were more solitary. The keeper should be a master of some manufacture; [1] a man of activity,[2] prudence, and temper. And he should keep his prisoners at work ten hours a day; mealtimes included.

For women, especially those that have children with them, and sometimes at the breast, there should be a chimney in one or two rooms: and in winter they should be allowed firing. I have known infants starved to death for want of this.[3] In some prisons where firing is allowed, the smoke has no vent but at the doors and windows. There should be a separate room or two for faulty apprentices, as at Tothill-fields, Clerkenwell, St. George's Fields, etc.[4] And two airy rooms for the sick: with medical relief. Men and women should be here entirely separated, as well as in gaols, to prevent the debauchery and vice so generally practised in our prisons. They should have workshops, as well as night-rooms, separate.[5] There

[1] The acts cited in a preceding note require that houses of correction have "mills, turns, cards, and such-like necessary implements, to set rogues or other idle persons on work." And the act seventeenth George II quoted in a former note, requires that the justices at their quarter-sessions "take effectual care that the houses of correction . . . be duly fitted up, furnished, and supplied with sufficient implements, materials, and furniture, for keeping, relieving, setting to work, employing, and correcting all idle and disorderly persons, rogues, vagabonds, etc."

[2] It was remarked that a gaoler should not be an old or infirm person; the same caution is requisite with regard to the keeper of a bridewell; since such an one would neither be able to keep the prisoners properly at work, nor to prevent their making their escape at the time of locking up, as I knew to happen at Preston in Lancashire, and other places.

[3] Not having sufficiently insisted on the necessity of an allowance of firing in gaols, I take occasion here to observe, that this is not only what humanity demands in our climate, but that it is essential to the preservation of the health of prisoners, by promoting the circulation of air, and preventing those mortifications of the feet to which they are so liable. I well know, that the want of firing joined to scanty provision, has been the cause of great mortality in our prisons during the winter. In one of these houses three prisoners were starved to death, only one halfpenny being found on them all. I waited on the coroner (who from the humanity of our laws must be applied to in such a case) and he acquainted me, that the verdict brought in was by the visitation of God, otherwise, the keeper would have been liable to a prosecution for felony, and might have been hanged; whereas, the fault lay with the justices, who had ordered an allowance not sufficient to support nature.

[4] Boys confined for correction should always be separate from other prisoners, and indeed from one another. A kind and tender monitor should often see them, and without tiring their attention, converse with them as a parent or a friend.

[5] In all prisons, it would be an excellent improvement to have crib beds for each person, like those at Haslar, and the Royal Hospital at Plymouth. These may be made of cast iron, without sides, nearly as cheap as of